▼ GLASSHOUSE



OFFICE RIVALRY

Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav has unveiled the party's latest outpost, PDA Bhawan, a sleek office-cum-residence on the Azamgarh-Faizabad highway. Set in a two-acre plot in Anwar Ganj, the two-storey complex is named after the SP's new social alliance formula of Pichhda, Dalit, Alpasankhyak (Backward, Dalit, Minority), and will be the party's Purvanchal "nerve centre" ahead of the 2027 UP election. At the ribbon-cutting ceremony, Akhilesh couldn't resist a jab at his saffron rivals. "I've seen the BJP's party offices, but ours is far better," he said, smiling. In the run-up to 2027, bricks or brickbats, all is fair.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ HOW COOL IS YOUR KHADI?

NEW DRESS CODE

Once the sartorial soul of the Congress party, khadi is now passe in Kerala. The younger leaders, inspired by Rahul Gandhi's Bharat Jodo makeover, are ditching the handspun fabric for jeans and T-shirts. The style shift triggered a full-blown generational debate after ex-PCC general secretary and khadi loyalist **Ajay Tharayil**, 66, took to social media to mourn the loss. While PCC president **Sunny Joseph** and LoP **V.D. Satheesan** defended the new-gen "comfort look", youth leaders like K.S. Sabarinadhan, V.T. Balram, Abin Varkey and Hibi Eden doubled down on their style, calling it smart, relatable and still "very Congressi". Guess in Kerala, the party's old-versus-new debate is now stitched into the seams.

